

Sarayu Ramnath | Curriculum Vitae

EDUCATION

Master of Environmental Science and Management (June 2026)

Bren School of Environmental Science & Management – University of California, Santa Barbara

Specialization: Coastal Resource Management | Focus: Environmental Communication.

Highlighted Coursework: Environmental Writing, Coastal and Environmental Policy, Marine Conservation and Management, Environmental Law, Data Visualization, GIS.

Extracurricular Activities: KCSB Radio, Career Development Student Assistant, Marine debris and habitat restoration (Channel Islands National Park).

Bachelor of Science, Animal Science (March 2017)

California State Polytechnic University, Pomona

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Associate | Conservation International, Santa Barbara, CA (11/24–Present)

- Co-author a 40-page climate vulnerability assessment for 11 marine megafauna species in the Eastern Tropical Pacific, contributing to synthesis structure, drafting, policy recommendations, and revisions.
- Support international project coordination including facilitating meetings, managing data use agreements, and presenting findings to donors, partners, and research collaborators across climate modeling and taxonomic expert teams.
- Conduct spatial vulnerability mapping and develop habitat suitability rasters to identify high-risk habitats; visualize overlap of species distribution and anthropogenic pressures across study regions.

Co-Project Manager & Data Manager | Environmental Baseline Assessment of Chumash Heritage National Marine Sanctuary - Master's Group Project, Santa Barbara, CA (4/25 – 6/26)

- Co-authored a 150-page evidence-based management report for Chumash Heritage National Marine Sanctuary, synthesizing historical oceanographic, biodiversity, and human-use data to inform sanctuary management decisions for staff, scientists, and rightsholders.
- Co-led project coordination and data infrastructure; facilitated team meetings, brought in external guidance to advance analysis and reporting, and recruited and mentored an undergraduate data intern.
- Consolidated and analyzed 30+ years of seabird and marine mammal survey data in R; executed data quality and spatio-temporal analyses for species richness and community composition.
- Organized Github repository structure and data workflows; trained team members on version control and documentation; developed reproducible workflows and metadata standards; produced publication-ready data visualizations for technical and public audiences.

Communications Capstone | UCSB Natural Reserve System, Santa Barbara, CA (3/26–6/26)

- Developed 4 data visualizations in R, 1 infographic, and authored a blog post communicating UCSB Natural Reserve System's statewide role in supporting research, education, and public service.
- Analyzed internal RAMS metrics data to identify key indicators for public communication; developed reproducible GitHub workflow to support annual updates.
- Collaborated with the executive director to contextualize system-level data, ensuring visualizations accurately reflect on-the-ground perspectives for public and partner audiences.

Channel Islands Marine Debris Cleanup Coordinator | National Marine Sanctuary Foundation (NMSF), Ventura, CA (8/23–12/23)

- Coordinated Northern Channel Islands marine debris cleanups through collaboration with NMSF, Channel Islands National Marine Sanctuary (CINMS), local conservation partners, and fishermen.
- Established internal ArcGIS mapping protocol for ongoing marine debris cleanup tracking; authored project summary used in grant situation reports for NMSF and CINMS.
- Developed outreach strategy for CINMS balloon pollution prevention campaign, adapted existing materials into a targeted social media schedule and coordinated cross-organization promotion.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE CONTINUED

Social Media Coordinator | Point Blue Conservation Science, Petaluma, CA (9/20–7/22)

- Developed public outreach strategies and produced original content across Instagram, Facebook, LinkedIn, and Twitter; tracked and analyzed engagement metrics to inform content decisions, doubling followers, engagement, and reach within 6 months.
- Collaborated with scientists, community organizations, and partners across 7 programs to translate conservation research into accessible content for broad public audiences.
- Managed and wrote a monthly Mailchimp newsletter for ~120 staff as part of organization-wide DEI Working Group initiatives.

Marine Ecology Research Assistant | Point Blue Conservation Science & CICESE, CA & Baja California Sur, México (2017-2022)

- Conducted field and laboratory research on seabird, pinniped, and shorebird ecology, including breeding productivity and predator-prey dynamics, supporting management decisions across Greater Farallones and Cordell Bank National Marine Sanctuaries.
- Managed and processed ecological datasets spanning 60+ years and 13 research projects; trained 4 volunteers in standardized data collection protocols, and extended museum outreach.
- Performed demographic studies in the Farallon Islands and 15 California Least tern breeding colonies; developed spatial analyses and figures for USFWS Black brant census report and coordinated cross-border research with México-based partner Terra Peninsular.

REPORTS & PRESENTATIONS

Ramnath S., Gonzales L., Brito-Morales I., Hannah L., et al. *Save the Blue 5 Climate Vulnerability Assessment for Marine Megafauna in the Eastern Tropical Pacific*. Conservation International, 2026. In review. (report).

Hatfield M., **Ramnath S.**, Smith C., Graham M., Castillo A. *Baseline Environmental Assessment of Chumash Heritage National Marine Sanctuary*. Bren School of Environmental Science & Management, 2026. Forthcoming, *Dryad*. (report).

CalCOFI Conference, San Diego, California (May 2026): *Oceanography and Marine Megafauna in Chumash Heritage National Marine Sanctuary* (poster).

Species on the Move, Rìyuè tán, Taiwan (April 2026): *A Synthesis of Climate-Driven Distribution Shifts in Eastern Pacific Megafauna* (talk).

American Geophysical Union, New Orleans, Louisiana (December 2025): *Building Inclusive Team Frameworks in Cryosphere Research: Reflections from the Field* (poster).

Center for Alaskan Coastal Studies, Homer, Alaska (August 2025): *Collaborative Research and Public Data to Understand a Dynamic Pacific* (talk).

GRANTS & AWARDS

UCSB Graduate Division Individualized Professional Skills Grant, \$1200 (2026)

Species on the Move Young Scholar Award, \$625 (2026)

Bren Special Opportunities Fund \$1200 (2025)

MPA Collaborative Network Early Career Scholarship \$1300 (2024)

UCSB Bren School Student Recruitment Fellowship, \$31,704 (2024-2025)

SKILLS

Policy & Communication: Technical and public writing, community and partner engagement, public speaking, interagency project coordination.

Science Communication & Engagement: Hootsuite, Affinity Designer, Mailchimp.

GIS & Spatial Analysis: ArcGIS, QGIS, Google Colab, Google Earth Engine, R(terra, sf, leaflet).

Data Management & Computing: Microsoft Access, Git/GitHub, R/RStudio, Quarto.

Languages: Spanish (proficient).